

ANGEL ACTION · BONES & JOINTS

Fractures (Broken Bones)

Keep the injured limb still, control any bleeding, immobilise with a padded splint or sling, check circulation every 15 minutes, and seek medical aid. Call 000 for open fractures, large bones or signs of shock.

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Signs

- Pain, especially on movement
- Tenderness over the bone
- Swelling and bruising
- Deformity or unnatural position
- Loss of function or weight-bearing
- Grating noise or feeling
- Open wound with bone visible (open fracture)

What to do

1. Follow **DRSABCD**.
2. Keep the person still and reassure them.
3. Control any bleeding with direct pressure (around exposed bone, not on it).
4. **Immobilise** the limb in the position found, using padded splints or by binding to the body / opposite limb.
5. Use a sling for upper limb fractures where possible.
6. Check circulation beyond the injury (warmth, colour, pulse) every **15 minutes**. Loosen bandages if numbness or coldness develops.
7. Treat for **shock**.
8. Seek medical aid. Call **000** for large bones (femur, pelvis), open fractures, multiple fractures or signs of shock.

Do NOT

- Do not try to push a bone back into place.
- Do not give food or water — surgery may be needed.
- Do not move the person unnecessarily.

*Adapted from **Australian First Aid 5th Edition**. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.*